

POETRY ANALYSIS in TWENTY QUESTIONS

Rapert/AP Lit
For use with all poetry

General Questions for Poetry Analysis and Evaluation for

(poem) _____

1. Who is the **speaker**? What kind of person is the speaker?
2. Is there an identifiable **audience** for the speaker? What can we know about it (her, him, or them)?
3. What is the **occasion**?
4. What is the **setting** in time (hour, season, century, and so on)?
5. What is the **setting** in place (indoors or out, city or country, land or sea, region, nation, hemisphere)?
6. What is the central **purpose** of the poem?
7. State the central idea or **theme** of the poem in a sentence.
8. Discuss the **tone** of the poem. How is it achieved?
9.
 - a. Outline the poem so as to show its structure and development, or
 - b. Summarize the events of the plot.
10. Paraphrase the poem [read it and paraphrase it in SENTENCES] (if the work is long, simply paraphrase difficult passages).
11. Discuss the **diction** of the poem. Point out words that are particularly well chosen and explain why.
12. Discuss the **imagery** of the poem. What kinds of imagery are used?
13. Point out examples of **metaphor, simile, personification**, and **metonymy** and explain their function.
14. Point out and explain any **symbols**. If the poem is allegorical, explain the allegory.
15. Point out and explain examples of **paradox, overstatement, understatement, and irony**.
What is their function?
16. Point out and explain any **allusions**. What is their function?
17. Point out significant examples of **sound repetition** and explain their function.

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18. Discuss the **adaptation** of sound to sense and mood.
19. Describe the **form** or **structural pattern** of the poem.
20. **Criticize** and **evaluate** the poem.